

committed, that they are not violating on the sly?

INDIA TODAY But why is politics so divisive? Can all three of you come together on the delivery mechanism and administrative reforms?

Chaudhary Recently my party began an agitation on price hike and even though my party is very small with only five MPs, the entire Opposition joined in, including a few belonging to the ruling coalition. There is issue-based support across party lines. The larger problem is to break the hold of identity politics. Also, money is still not considered good in our country. So any politician who talks openly about it is not considered morally upright.

Nanda The other question is, what is the role of the media? How can the media break stories of politicians spending more, if it is asking for money to carry their stories?

INDIA TODAY You will have to make a start and say okay, I will not pay. Don't carry my story.

Swamy A novel thought, but how do we ensure our opponents do the same?

INDIA TODAY What are the issues that dominate this generation's mindset?

Hooda I think unemployment and unemployability are the main issues. On the one hand NASSCOM predicts a shortfall of millions of qualified engineers, on the other hand you see lakhs of people applying for jobs of police constables or clerks. The second thing is infrastructure. Young people see the good life and the fact that India's growth may not be percolating as fast as they want. So, the real challenge ahead of us is how to deliver on their expectations, that too at a fast pace.

INDIA TODAY Do you think China is the new Pakistan?

Swamy That relationship is not well defined. We should be a lot smarter on how we handle China. I don't think we have done our part.

INDIA TODAY Should there be a retirement age for politicians?

Hooda I think there should be, if not a retirement age, a time till somebody is able to perform to the best of their abilities. Ultimately, in a democracy,

it goes back to the people. Experience is a valuable asset but if someone's mental capacity is compromised, he must retire. But we cannot expect the young to start running the country overnight.

Chaudhary I feel it is entirely up to the individual but the whole argument of experience has also been stretched in our context. Twenty years in the profession is long

enough. If I haven't made an impression till then, what is the point?

Hooda People are sharp. They can easily judge a 50-year-old candidate who does not deliver and a 70-year-old who does.

Swamy There should be no retirement age for politicians. Let people decide for themselves.

Galhotra There should be a retirement age for them which must not go beyond 60.

Nanda The number of terms whether in state legislatures or in Parliament must be fixed.

Hooda No party will remove a four-time standing member unless circumstances are against him.

INDIA TODAY But why is art silent in all this?

Galhotra Because there are a few decision-makers sitting over there who would like to make statues like Mayawati did. We don't have people to understand the new generation of artists. We need to hire a group and educate the authorities about contemporary art. They don't see commercial viability in radical art. So ultimately artists have to get regular jobs or go to galleries to do commercial work—things that kill the real artist.

INDIA TODAY Every generation talks about making a change. What makes you different from the last decade?

Swamy Twenty or 30 years ago, we were technology observers. After some time, we became its followers and have remained so till date. This country is more focused on capitalising on our human resources, which is good. We need to build next generation companies—how can you create the next generation Google, IBM or Sony in India? We also need to ensure that intellectual property rights are protected.

Hooda An important change is the fast pace at which this generation wants things done. Their expectations are very high and they are empowered, technologically and politically. If they can forget about flaunting fancy mobile phones, hanging around malls and start taking risks, I think the future is bright. ■

